Discussion questions

The Day I Tried to Run on Pure Sparkles · for reading aloud at home, book clubs and classrooms

Pick two or three — not all of them. There are no wrong answers here, only unfinished ones. The best answers start with "because."

Before reading

1. Look at the bottle on the cover. What is it promising? How can you tell?
2. The title says pure sparkles. What do you think a person would be trying to run on?
3. The back cover says, "My body has its own opinions." What could a body's opinion be?

During reading — chapter stops

Chapter 1 · For Champions Only *page 1*

1. Coach says, "Drink water before the match." Jiwoo says water has never won anything. What does Jiwoo believe about her bottle — and why?
2. "Therefore: this bottle = winning." Is that a good therefore? What would you need to know to be sure?

Chapter 2 · A Champion Pours *page 6*

1. What clues tell you that Lumi is a scientist?
2. Lumi says, "Ten cubes is not the problem. Ten cubes right now is." What do you think right now means?

Chapter 3 · Just for Safety *page 10*

1. Lumi doesn't try to stop Jiwoo again, and Jiwoo thinks, (Somehow that is worse.) Why might that feel worse?
2. Jiwoo pushes her breakfast away: "Champions travel light." What do you predict will happen at the match?

Chapter 4 · I Am Electric *page 13*

1. Jiwoo feels AMAZING. Lumi writes it down: "Subject reports: electric." Why would a scientist record a feeling?
2. Why do you think Jiwoo doesn't pass the ball?

Chapter 5 · Wet Spaghetti *page 18*

1. Look at how the sentences change: "Something. Shifts." How does the writing help you feel the change?
2. Where in your body do you notice it first when you get tired?

Chapter 6 · The Insulin Crew *page 22*

1. Explain the Insulin Crew to someone who hasn't read the book.
2. Jiwoo whispers, "I should have had toast." Is that the whole answer? (Peek at Lumi's notes on page 42.)

Chapter 7 · Sip This Slowly *page 26*

1. Coach Lee doesn't say "I told you so." Why do you think she doesn't?
2. At halftime Theo sits next to Jiwoo and says nothing. Can saying nothing be kind?

Chapter 8 · Sorry, Lightning Kick *page 30*

1. Why does Jiwoo say sorry to a cartoon?
2. Jiwoo learns three things. Which one matters most to you? What is the difference between Lightning Kick and Lightning Kick's drink?

After reading — the big questions

1. Lumi says, "Feeling nothing is real data too." Why would a scientist care when nothing happens?
2. Four things were true at once on match day (page 42). If you could change only ONE, which would you choose — and why only one?
3. Have you ever believed something because of an ad, a character or a label?
4. The drink in this story is a hero's drink, not a "bad" drink. Why do you think the author wrote it that way?
5. If Lumi followed you around today, what would she write on her clipboard?

In the car, at dinner — short versions for families

- What's one thing your body told you today?
- Did anything today promise more than it delivered?
- What did you notice today that nobody else did?

There are no wrong answers here. There are unfinished ones. — L.